

Ryan Lai

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EDUCATION

University of New South Wales, Sydney, Australia

Feb 2024 – Now

- Bachelor of Commerce (Finance and Business Analytics)
- Relevant Course Work: International Business Finance, Behavioural Finance, Quant Business Analytics, Programming for Data Analytics, Portfolio Management, Wealth Management.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TOTO Ltd., FP&A Intern

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

- Supported the budgeting and forecasting cycle across multiple cost centers, delivering enhanced financial visibility into operational expenditure.
- Conducted actual-versus-budget variance analysis to surface key cost drivers and inform management decision-making.
- Contributed to the preparation of monthly management reporting packs, tracking performance against established financial targets.
- Reviewed cost center structures and standard costing data to identify opportunities for improved resource allocation and operational efficiency.
- Leveraged SAP ERP to extract, validate, and interpret financial data underpinning reporting and analytical deliverables.

Bank for Investment and Development of Vietnam (BIDV), Credit Analyst Intern

July 2024 – Sep 2024

- Conducted credit analysis on 10+ client profiles (AUD 300k–420k exposure) to support loan approval and risk assessment.
- Contributed to the preparation of asset valuation reports across real estate and collateral-backed instruments, ensuring accuracy of underlying security assessments.
- Partnered with senior analysts to evaluate asset performance and identify emerging credit risks.
- Developed a strong working knowledge of lending structures, mortgage products, and credit risk frameworks applied within a commercial banking environment.

UAWS NSW: Vietnamese Students in NSW, Event & Finance Coordinator

Feb 2025 – Present

- Promoted inclusive student participation and strengthened community ties.
- Managed budgeting and financial planning (up to 11k AUD) for society events, ensuring accuracy in financial reports.

ACADEMIC PROJECT

FX Exposure & Hedging Case Study — Micron Technology (MU)

- Estimated Micron Technology's USD FX exposure by running CAPM and DXY-augmented regressions on monthly returns from Aug 2001 to Dec 2024, isolating market beta from currency beta.
- Analyzed Micron's operational currency exposure through its 10-K filings, mapping revenue and manufacturing footprint across Asian and US markets to support the empirical findings.
- Designed a hedging strategy using ICE US Dollar Index (DXY) futures, sizing contracts against a USD 1M equity position and modelling transaction costs across entry, exit, and futures P&L.

Markowitz & Single Index Model Portfolio Optimization

- Built minimum variance frontiers and identified Global Minimum Variance and Optimal Risky Portfolios for a 10-stock portfolio (ADBE, MCD, BLK, GOOGL, AMZN, MA, IBM, JPM, WMT, CVX) using monthly return data from 2014–2018, under both long/short and long-only constraints.
- Derived the Capital Allocation Line and computed the Optimal Complete Portfolio by maximizing utility under a personalized risk aversion coefficient, integrating risk-free and risky asset allocation decisions.
- Estimated CAPM-style regressions to obtain each stock's beta and idiosyncratic variance, then constructed a SIM-based variance-covariance matrix to re-derive efficient portfolios under the single-index assumption.

AWARDS & CERTIFICATION

Case Competition: BISA X UNSW WIT X Capgemini 2025 Case Competition Finalist

Award: 2nd place in the International Elementz Fair (Chemistry Award) 2022

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Language: IELTS (Score: 8.0), Vietnamese (Native)

Skills:

- **Technical:** SQL, R, Tableau, Java, and Excel
- **Finance:** DCF, Comparable Company Analysis, Budgeting, Hedging, Behavioural Finance.

CFA Level 1 (Ongoing)